

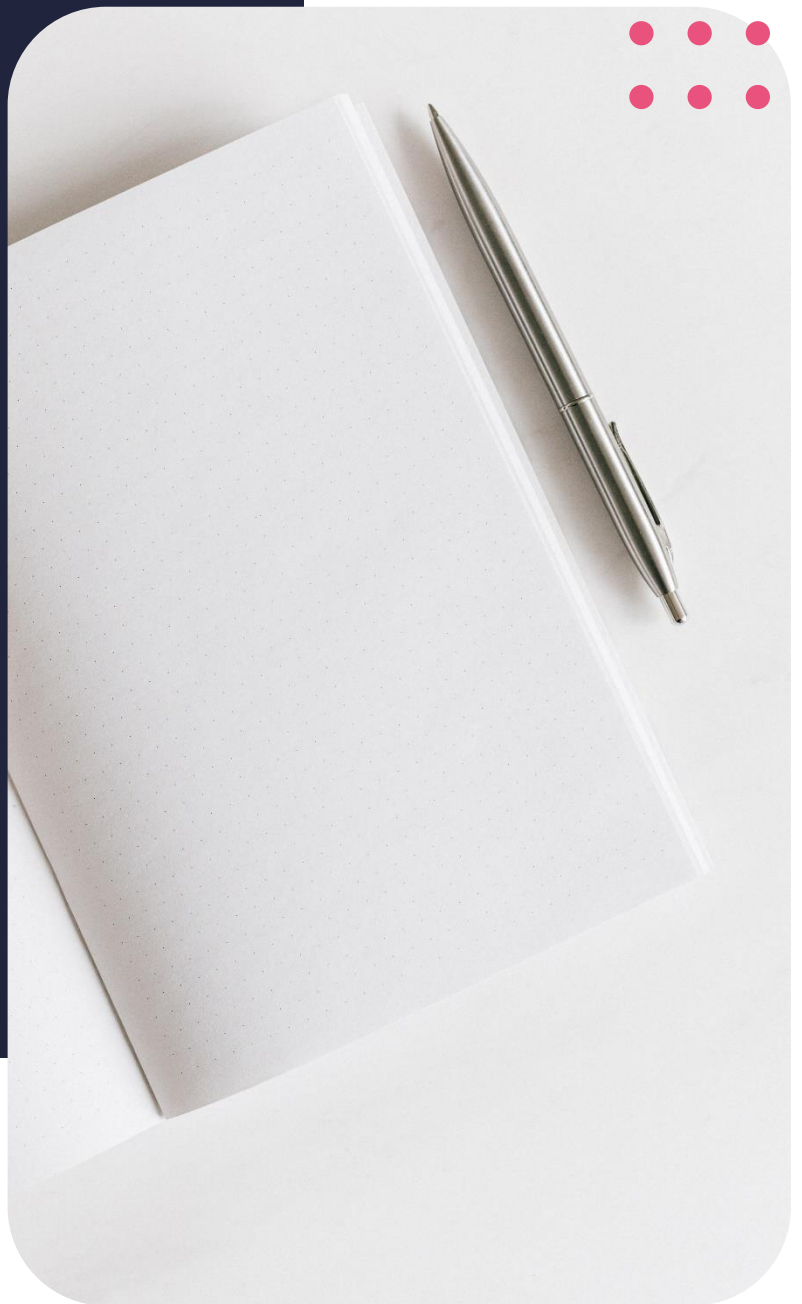
Diploma in Leadership & Management

Your Guide to EQ and how to use Persuasion



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Lesson 2 Objectives

- Your EQ Introduction
- EQ Tools & Approaches
- The Power of Persuasion

Lesson Introduction

“Emotional intelligence (otherwise known as emotional quotient or EQ) is the ability to understand, use, and manage your own emotions in positive ways to relieve stress, communicate effectively, empathize with others, overcome challenges and defuse conflict. ... Social awareness – You have empathy.” (Help guide , 2020)

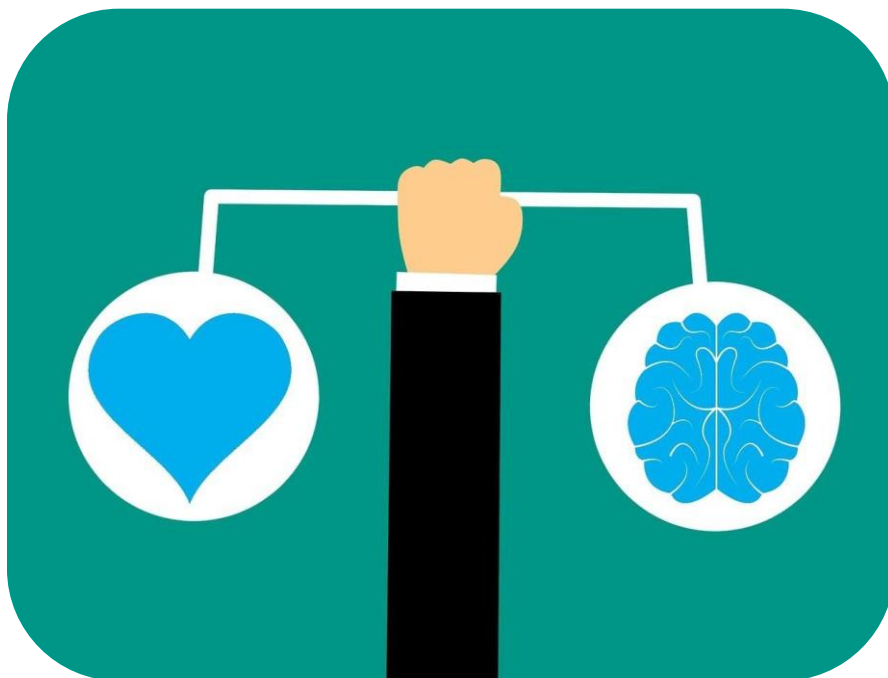
EQ in combination with IQ is such an amazing tool that managers and leaders can use in the workplace. You can use EQ to connect better with those around you while you use IQ to better problem solve. As part of gaining more influence in the workplace, top managers and leaders make use of persuasion in the workplace.

Key reading materials

<https://www.forbes.com/sites/jasonnazar/2013/03/26/the-21-principles-of-persuasion/>

<https://theconversation.com/eq-versus-iq-whats-the-perfect-management-mix-40001>

<https://theundercoverrecruiter.com/emotional-intelligence-iq-leadership/>

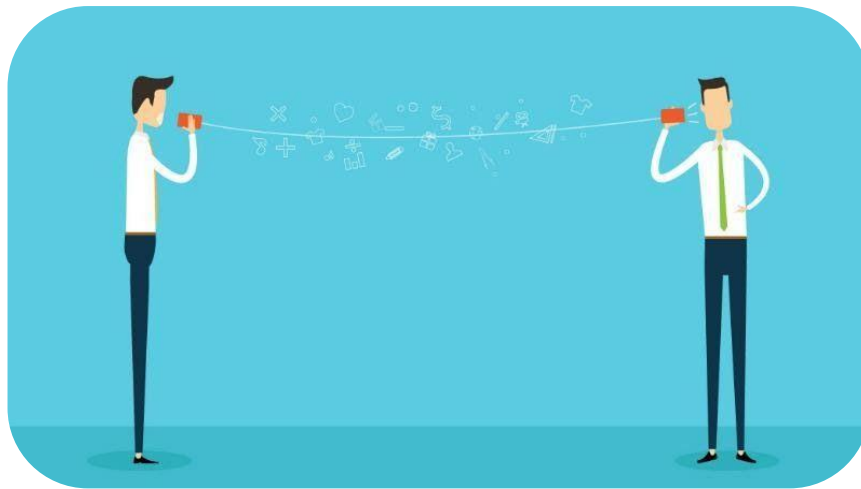


Persuasion techniques to give you an edge in the workplace



According to (Chignell, 2019) there are various techniques and approaches that you can take to use persuasion effectively in the workplace. Let us have a look at the following techniques.

The framing method:



“Carefully describing or explaining something in such a way that influences how the recipient interprets the information being given is known as ‘framing’. Take the classic example of a glass that is ‘half full’ or ‘half empty’ – the first phrase sounds much more positive, even though the same object is being described in both instances.” (Chignell, 2019)

This method has a few core elements that need to be taken into account:

- Placement, make sure that you’re selecting the correct time and plan

- Approach, think of the argument you want to present to the person(s) that you're trying to persuade. This will help you determine your approach and if it will work. You can also ask for feedback and advice when it comes to your approach.
- Words, think before you speak. Think of the types of words that you're using and how effective each word/sentence is.

Using we instead of you:

Here you can take the approach to use the word 'we' instead of saying 'you'. It helps the persona understand that you're both in this together and it's not just up to the person to change or do something on their own.

Explain the benefits:

"One great way of persuading people is to explain the benefits that will affect them specifically. If someone can see and appreciate that agreeing with you will offer advantages to them personally, they'll be much more inclined to agree with you." (Chignell, 2019)

As mentioned during the lesson, we need to explain the benefits of the different projects or changes that you're proposing. People need to know why something is happening and how it will impact them. Ideally, people want to know that a new idea or change will benefit them in some way. As a manager or leader, you can use this to ensure that people feel like they are winning when you use persuasion effectively.

Create a sense of urgency:

"Creating a real need for something, or a time constraint, makes people want something more than if it were abundantly available. Think about the limited-edition products that brands launch – the fact that consumers believe they may miss the opportunity to own something new makes them rush out to buy them." (Chignell, 2019)

We want employees to feel that there is a need to change. When people are too comfortable of they don't see any pressure of the need to change, they are less likely to do so. Keep that in mind when you're pushing for change. Also think of how you can use a sense of urgency in your persuasion.

Get agreement on a more minor point first

"In a sales environment, this is known as the 'yes ladder' – by getting someone to agree with a minor point, or to carry out a smaller task, you will be more likely to get them to agree with a bigger project." (Chignell, 2019)

Start small and then build on that 'yes' that you receive from your team or employees. It's much easier to ask for something big if the employees saw the positive impact of the small yes.

Focus on the data:

This is such an important point. When you want someone to listen to use or accept your change, use data to support your case. "If you have evidence and data that supports your idea – whether that's from academic studies, surveys you've spotted in the press, examples of good industry practice, or research that you've undertaken within your organisation – your proposal will carry more weight." (Chignell, 2019)

Take your body language into account:



Your body language impacts your persuasion. Keep that in mind as we review the following impact of each gesture

- Smiling naturally – makes you seem approachable and likable
- Raising your eyebrows – signals you are not a threat, and are friendly and approachable
- Avoid crossing your arms and putting your hands in your pockets – signals that you don't feel comfortable and makes you appear less approachable
- A visible neck – shows that you are unthreatening and easy to approach
- Eye contact – shows interest in the conversation and trustworthiness
- Wear colour – complementary colours make people stand out and seem more attractive
- Show your palms – indicates you are telling the full story

Persuasion exercises

According to (Skills converged , n.d.)

Purpose

The ability to persuade people is a useful skill both in personal and professional life. This exercise is ideal once you have covered persuasion skills in your training course and want to go through a more demanding exercise that requires people to persuade each other strongly. It is an entertaining exercise as it involves everyone in a simple yet powerful setting.

To truly get the best from this exercise, you can follow it with a review and discussion. You will need to take notes during the exercise as each can play differently. You will need to refer back to the strategies used by participants while persuading each other during discussions. You can then comment on the effectiveness of these techniques and get delegates to discuss them.

Objective

Persuade the other person to move out of a circular area completely without touching or using any physical force.

What You Need

- A rope about 8m long. Lay this as a circle on the floor to create a perimeter.
- Prize

Setup

- Ask for two volunteers. Pick two that are very competitive or think they are very persuasive. These two will go through the persuasion exercise while others watch.
- Setup the environment much like a wrestling match where one needs to push the other out of a circular area.
- Ask the two volunteers to stand in the middle of the circle. The audience should remain outside of the circle.
- Explain that each person's goal is to get the other person to go out of the circle.
- The rules are:
 - They cannot touch each other or use physical force.
 - They can use any influence technique they like including arguments, lecturing, deception, diplomacy, bribing, etc.
- Ask the audience to cheer and encourage the people in the ring.
- Explain that there will be a prize for the winner but don't say what it is.
- Start the match.
- Allocate 15 minutes for this part.
- Take notes about the conversation and the strategies used to convince one another. You will need to refer back to these during discussions.
- The game is over if a contestant is convinced to step out of the circle or the time is up.
- Give the prize to the winner.
- Follow with a discussion.

Timing

- Explaining the Exercise: 5 minutes
- Activity: 15 minutes
- Group Feedback: 10 minutes

Discussion

- Who truly won this match; the person who remained in the circle or the person who stepped out in exchange for something he negotiated?
 - What influencing strategies were employed during this match?
 - Whose methods were more effective?
 - Who was more convincing?
 - Did any of the contestants offer something in return for getting the other person to step out?
 - What was offered and was it accepted or not?
 - How did the contestants negotiate over this?
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- What was the role of the audience?
- Did the audience offer help and advice or influence the decisions in any way?
- What is the most important lesson you have learned in this exercise in regard with persuasion skills?
- What would you do differently if there was no prize for the winner?

EQ Model

According to (Six seconds , 2019) “Emotional intelligence is the capacity to blend thinking and feeling to make optimal decisions — which is key to having a successful relationship with yourself and others. To provide a practical and simple way to learn and practice emotional intelligence, Six Seconds developed a three-part model in 1997 as a process – an action plan for using emotional intelligence in daily life.”

Look at this model as an exercise for yourself. This model can be used in order for you to better understand yourself. You can use this model in a personal or professional capacity.



(Six seconds , 2019)

Know Yourself

Clearly seeing what you feel and do.

Emotions are data, and these competencies allow you to accurately collect that information.

Choose Yourself

Doing what you mean to do.

Instead of reacting “on autopilot,” these competencies allow you to proactively respond.

Give Yourself

Doing it for a reason.

These competencies help you put your vision and mission into action so you lead on purpose and with full integrity.

You can use this model to create a worksheet for your team. Write down your understanding of each section of this model. You can also rate how effective you currently are in each section. This is a great starting point to see if you're on track and where you need to improve. For example, maybe you're someone that switches to autopilot in a tough situation, but you need to be more present and in control of your emotion.

EQ exercises

According to (Skills converged , n.d.)



Purpose

This exercise helps delegates explore the concept of temperament, understand what it means, how it is formed, and how it can influence their emotional intelligence. Temperament refers to aspects of an individual's personality that are mainly biological or innate as opposed to learning.

Temperament is basically life-long traits that we have acquired early on in life or simply inherited. Here are some examples:

- “I am shy in social settings. I feel uncomfortable if I suddenly find myself at the center of attention. I guess it comes from my childhood when I was brought up to be a quiet kid.”
 - “I was never very sporty or physical when I was growing up so engaging in sports these days doesn't appeal to me much. Where I grow up, it was frowned upon for girls to do sports.”
 - “I like talking. If I enter a room and it is quiet I have the strongest urge to talk and get everyone to listen. I got this from my mom I guess...” [Carries on talking for a while until stopped!]
 - “I have always been sporty, even though I was a girl I always liked any sport even if they were predominantly for boys. I guess I got this from my dad who was very athletic.”
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- In this exercise, delegates explore the nature of their temperament and discuss this with others to better understand what it means.

Objective

Answer the questions provided in the form and then discuss it with a partner.

What You Need

- A copy of the “Temperament Questionnaire” for each delegate provided below.

Setup

- Explain that temperament is influenced by a mixture of parameters such as the following:
 - o Genetic Inheritance
 - Physical attributes
 - Life Experiences
 - Environmental Conditions
- Divide the delegates to pairs. If you have an odd number of delegates use a group of 3.
- Distribute a copy of the “Temperament Questionnaire” to each delegate.
- Ask each delegate to answer the questions provided in the form. At this stage, each person works on his own.
- Allocate 15 minutes for this part.
- Ask pairs to share what they recorded on their forms in each group. Each person should take turns to explain what they think of their temperaments. They should also discuss the last question on what they potentially want to change.
- Allocate 15 minutes for this part.
- Bring back everyone together and follow with a discussion.

Timing

- Explaining the Exercise: 5 minutes
- Activity: 15 min answering questions + 15 min sharing = 30 minutes
- Group Feedback: 10 minutes

Discussion

- What do you think of the effect of your temperament on your everyday life?
 - How did your partners’ temperament differ from yours?
 - Was it easy to come up with strategies on how to change or modify some of the behaviors discussed?
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